

Fewer than 500 vote in Acushnet Election

By Beth David
Editor

Less than 6% of voters turned out for the Acushnet election Saturday, 5/18/24, at the Acushnet Elementary School, where all precincts voted. There were no contested races on the ballot, and there were three vacancies. A total of 498 ballots were cast out of 8,573 registered voters, for a turnout of 5.8%.

Kevin Gaspar was re-elected to his seat on the Selectboard with 437 votes; Francis Mello was elected Assessor with 438 votes; David Davignon was re-elected to the Board of Health with 452 votes; John Howcroft was re-elected to School Committee with 439 votes; Richard Ellis was re-elected to the Planning



L-R: Acushnet Selectboard member, Kevin Gaspar, and detail officer, retired police chief Michael Alves, pose for the local free sheet as voting wrapped up on 5/18/24 when Acushnet had no contested elections and saw a 5.8% turnout. *Photo by Beth David.*

Commission with 433 votes; Peter John Giampa was elected to fill an unexpired term on Planning with 425

votes; Paul Fortin was re-elected to the Cemetery Board with 460 votes; Alan Miner was elected to the Library board of Trustees with 442 votes; Chad Leclair was re-elected Park Commissioner with 443 votes; Andrew Gomes was re-elected to the Housing Authority with 439 votes;

Commissioner of Trust Funds had two vacant spots on the ballot, one for a full term and one for the remainder of an unexpired term. No names were on the ballot.

Trustee of the Free Public Library also had one vacant seat on the ballot.

If you are interested in serving in any of the vacant seats, contact the Town Clerk for more information, 608-998-0215.

Acushnet Selectboard still crunching the numbers

By Beth David
Editor

The Acushnet Selectboard canceled their meeting on Tuesday, 5/21/24 and scheduled a meeting for Thursday at 11 a.m. The agenda still has

budget items and the Town Meeting warrant on it.

The town is trying to close a budget shortfall that was at more than \$1 million at the start of budget season. Officials have steadily been

chipping away at the deficit with a series of budget cuts and reviewing revenue numbers. The state's budget, with the aid to cities and towns, is not yet finalized. Acushnet's Town Meeting will be held on Monday, 6/17.

Family Contratulates Espindola

Congratulations, Bob, on your retirement from the Fairhaven Board of Selectmen

We are so incredibly proud of you. Twelve years of service to the Town of Fairhaven is quite an accomplishment. Your dedication, compassion, and sacrifice were noticed and appreciated by so many.

To some, it may have appeared as though you fulfilled your selectboard duties just once a week, but we know firsthand what the position meant to you.

We saw the time and energy you poured into learning and understanding the issues put before the selectboard. If something needed to be researched and thoroughly vetted for the best possible outcome, you were right there putting in the work.

That's dedication.

When decisions needed to be made, you always had an open mind, and you listened intently to all involved.

That's compassion.

Even in times when life got busy, and you had to stretch yourself in different directions, you remained

steadfast in your responsibilities to the town and your fellow selectboard members.

That's sacrifice.

You are honest and have strong moral principles.

That's integrity.

Your time as a selectboard member was not always smooth sailing, we know that firsthand also. When faced with adversity, negativity, and outright disrespect from some, you upheld your position as a calm, fair and considerate leader. Your ability to keep your composure through what you endured was admirable.

In twelve years of service to the Town of Fairhaven, through it all — the easy and the challenging — you were unwavering and focused on facts and the proper order of the business for our town regardless of what entity, person or group was on the other side of the issue at hand.

That's consistency.

As your siblings, the difficult times were hard for us to witness, but your professionalism and decorum never faltered, and each time these types of situations arose, you proved your dedication, compassion, sacrifice,

integrity, and consistency. Truly, there are not many people who could have sustained and still conducted themselves with such grace.

As your siblings, we are immensely proud of you, and are honored to call you, our brother. Because of your repeated public display of poise and professionalism, we are proud to be Espindolas.

Mom and Dad are watching from heaven above, and we are certain they are so very proud of you also. They would be so proud of the man you have become. Your children are very lucky to have you and Ann as their loving parents and role models. We love you and Ann deeply and are so happy that you will get more time to spend with each other and with your beautiful grandchildren.

We wish you the very best in your retirement, and we thank you,

The Espindola Family

Planning Board Member Vows to Press On

Regrettably, our proposed recommendation to the Town Meeting members, advocating for the

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